

P.A.U.S.E Framework

P	Pause, pay attention.	Take time to notice body language, thoughts, feelings, and the safety of the environment.
A	Assess the situation, background.	Reflect on what is activating the situation and the context surrounding it. What is the intent versus impact? What relationship do you have with those involved? What objective, subjective, and psychosocial elements are contributing to the situation?
U	Understand and use.	Leverage the roots of these feelings, values, beliefs, and practices to gain trust and understanding among the involved parties. What values are being challenged, what are needed to gain resolution?
S	Safety and set boundaries.	Determine the safety of stepping in or not stepping in. If unsafe for any party, step away and escalate as appropriate. Set boundaries focusing on safety, respect and dignity. Use therapeutic communication to set clear limits on acceptable behavior using "I" statements, disengage physically or emotionally if the conversation degrades, and state clear consequences. Separate intent from impact: Remember that someone can cause harm with their bias even if they didn't mean to.
E	Empathize, Enforce, Evaluate, Escalate (if needed).	Validate the emotions and experiences of the affected individual. "I hear..." without confirming or denying the intent behind the biased action. Enforce established guidelines, ground your enforcement in official codes of conduct or workplace policies. Evaluate the need to escalate the concerns up the chain of command. Do you need to involve your faculty, a preceptor, the charge nurse, the nursing supervisor or administrator on duty, etc.



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